

Gitta Shrestha Thapa
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Professional Experience

November-December, 2022	MHH Consultant, UNICEF ROSA, Nepal
Since August 2016 – September 2022	National Researcher, International Water Management Institute, Nepal.
Since September 2015	Researcher, Wageningen University, Netherlands.
Since July 2012	Research Associate, Nepal Centre for Contemporary Research, Nepal.
Since October 2011	Researcher, University of Zurich, Switzerland.
Since November 2010	Market Research Manager, BioComp Nepal, Nepal.
Since January 2010	Research Associate, Interdisciplinary Analyst, Nepal.
Since January 2007	Program Officer, Nepal Institute of Development Studies, Nepal.
Since April 2005	Social Science Teacher, Creative Academy, Nepal.

Consultancy Contracts

August 2015	Documentary film translator, Swiss Network for International Studies, Switzerland.
July -December 2015	Research Associate, International Organization for Migration, Nepal.
July- August 2013, 2014,2015	Project Evaluation Team Leader, Social Welfare Council, Nepal.
April-May 2015	Live Interpreter, Multi-stakeholder Forestry Program, Mid-Term Review, Embassy of Switzerland, Nepal.
October 2009	Rapporteur, Outline, Nepal.

Education

August 2007-2009	MPhil in Human Geography, University of Bergen, Norway. MPhil Thesis: How Gender Affects Decision Making- A Case Study of Tibeto-Burmese Women in Kobang VDC, Mustang, Nepal. Supervisor: Prof. Peter Andersen
December 2003 - 2006	MA in Geography, Tribhuvan University, Nepal

Seminar Paper: Coffee Production in Nepal: Problem and Prospects.
Supervisor: Prof. Bhim Prasad Subedi

May 1998- 2001	BSc in Geography Honors, Calcutta University, India.	MA
Academic Training		Thesis: Squatter as an Urban Poor in the Valley: A Study on Livelihood
July 2023	Women4Climate: Developing Skills for Women Leadership in Climate Action. <u>Women4Climate Programme.</u>	
July 2022	Innovations and Scaling: An introductory online course. CGIAR. Ramhity, Kathmandu, Nepal	Strategy of the Urban Poor in
June 2019	“Gender, Development and Environmental Governance” 8.5 credit PhD course at the Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences in Uppsala, Sweden. [Water, Land and Ecosystems (WLE) Grant for researchers].	
August 2018	Certificate in 6 weeks online training course on - Beyond Grammar: Writing as thinking made visible. Red Plough International Co-operation Ltd.	
August 2018	SPSS. BRODAWAY Infosys. Nepal.	
July 2017	Justice Based Approach, United Edge.	
April 2014	Certificate in World Overview of Conservation Approaches and Technologies (WOCAT), Centre for Development and Environment (CDE), University of Bern, Switzerland.	
September 2012	Certificate in Forced Migration , The Mahanirban Calcutta Research Group (MCRG), India. [MCRG Grant]	
July 2011	Certificate in Geographic Information System (GIS) and Global Positioning System (GPS). Nepal GIS Society, Nepal.	
August 2006/7	Certificate in EmGIS University Level 6 Weeks. Royal Bhutan Institute of Technology, Bhutan and Salzburg University, Austria. [European Union Grant]	
June 2002 – June 2003	Certificate in Diploma in Desk Top Publishing , Computer Training Institute, State Youth Centre, India.	

Gender Training

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- The Consultative Group of International Agricultural Research (CGIAR) **Gender Researchers’ Leadership and Mentoring Program**, 2021-2022.
 - **Gender, Diversity and Inclusion** in CGIAR's Workplaces. CGIAR, 2021.
 - **Gender Equality and Social Inclusion Self-Assessment Tool**, Facilitation guide for WASH program managers, researchers and self-assessment facilitators Working Towards Transformation in Inclusive Water Sanitation and Hygiene. Water for Women Fund. 2019-2020.
 - **Gender Research and Integrated Training (GRIT)** workshop, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, 2018.
 - **Gender-Sensitive Governance Course:** Towards creating an enabling environment for gender equality and women empowerment (September 2014). Institute for Development Studies, UK and Voices for Change, Nigeria.

- E-Learning Course on ‘**Women, Leadership and Peacebuilding**’, United Institute for Training and Research, September 2014

Awards

- 5 years Distinguished Service Award, IWMI. 2021.
- The CGIAR Gender Researchers’ Leadership and Mentoring Program, 2021-2022.
- Norwegian Quota Scholarship (2007 –2009)
- National Centre for Competence in Research- NCCR North-South fund for master’s Thesis (2004-2005) □
Tribhuvan University Top achiever’s scholarship (2004)

Key Job Responsibilities

- Lead research on social inclusion, gender equality and environmental justice
- Design, coordinate and implement social science research projects
- Mainstream gender and social inclusion in the research process, design and implementation
- Design research methodology, framework and research tools
- Lead implementation of research and analysis of data.
- Produce research reports, policy briefs, blogs and journal articles
- Communicate research results to local, national and international stakeholders.
- Develop knowledge tools, modules and training materials; implement them in the field.
- Lead and contribute to project proposals and official documents
- Organize local and national level workshops
- Supervise research assistants, young research scholars, interns and consultants.

Projects

- Sustainable Intensification for Mixed Farming Systems (SI-MFS). 2022- 2024. CGIAR.
- NEXUS Gains: Realizing Multiple Benefits Across Water, Energy, Food and Ecosystems. 2022-2024. CGIAR.
- Solar irrigation for agricultural resilience in South Asia (Solar-SA) 2019-2023, Swiss Development Cooperation. Implementation: IWMI
- Youth Migration, Gender and Rural Agrarian Transformation, 2019- 2022, Water, Land and Ecosystems. Implementation. IWMI
- The Cereal Systems Initiative for South Asia (CSISA) Covid-19 Response and Resilience Activity (2021). USAID, CIMMYT, TAMU, Cornell University, iDE, IWMI.
- A Gender Perspective to Understand and Enhance the Functionality of Water Supply Systems: Lessons from Nepal (GP4WSF), 2019-2022. Water for Women. Australian Aid. Implementation IWMI.
- Vulnerability to Resilience of Those Left behind: Empowering Women, Children, and the Elderly to Cope with Water-Induced Disasters in the Mid-Hills and the Tarai Regions of Nepal. 2019-2022. International Development Research Centre, Canada.
- Sustainable, Just and Productive Water Resources Development in Western Nepal Project (Digo Jal Bikas), (2016 – 2019); USAID; IWMI-led consortium
- Poverty squares and gender circles: unravelling agricultural gaps, challenges and opportunities in the Eastern Gangetic Plains (2014-2018), The Australian Centre for International Agricultural Research (ACIAR), Australia. Implementation: IWMI-led consortium

- Conflict and Cooperation over Natural Resources (CoCooN), (2009-2018) Netherlands Water Organization (NWO); Wageningen University, Netherlands.
- Making Women Count for Peace: Gender, Empowerment, and Conflict in South Asia (2012-2015). Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO), Norway. Implementation: Nepal Centre for Contemporary Research
- Livelihoods, Basic Services and Social Protection in Post-conflict Nepal. (2012-2015). Secure Livelihood Research Consortium, ODI; Implementation: Nepal Centre for Contemporary Research
- Sustainable Land Management in the context of Outmigration and Climate Change in Nepal. (2012-2015) Swiss Network for International Studies, Switzerland. Implementation: Nepal Centre for Contemporary Research
- Feminization, agricultural transition, and rural employment: Social and political conditions of asset building in the context of export-led agriculture compared to alternative income-generating opportunities (2015-2018). Swiss National Science Foundation and Swiss Development Cooperation, Switzerland. Nepal Centre for Contemporary Research
- Transforming the lives of adolescent girls and young women (2013-2014), ODI, UK. Nepal Centre for Contemporary Research
- Why do so many go? Exploring the role of International Migration in livelihood recovery in post-conflict situations (2013-2014), ODI, UK, Nepal Centre for Contemporary Research
- Negotiating Public Authority: Local Development and Local Politics in Mid-Western Nepal from “War” to “Transition” (2009-2012) University of Zurich, Switzerland.
- Nationwide Survey on Peace and Security, 2010. Saferworld, Interdisciplinary Analyst.
- In-Depth Survey on Armed Violence in the Tarai, 2010. Governance Baseline Study of HRGGP-III, ESP Extended Phase and RDIF-II, Phase II’. Saferworld, Interdisciplinary Analyst.

Publications

Journal Articles

- 2024** Do Water, Energy and Food Nexus Policies Enable Gender Transformative Changes? Evidence from Bangladesh and Nepal. *Frontiers*. DOI: 10.3389/fsufs.2023.1159867. **Co-author.**
- 2023** Women who do not migrate: Intersectionality, social relations, and participation in Western Nepal." *World Development* 161:106109. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.worlddev.2022.106109>. **Lead author.**
Technology for whom. Solar Irrigation Pumps, women and smallholders in Eastern Tarai. Nepal. *Front. Sustain. Food Syst*, Accepted for publication. DOI: 10.3389/fsufs.2023.1143546, **Lead author.**
“Gender and Socially Inclusive WASH in Nepal: Moving Beyond ‘Technical Fixes’” *Frontiers*. DOI: 10.3389/fhumd.2023.1181734. **Co-author.**
- 2022** Are climate finance subsidies equitably distributed among farmers? Assessing socio-demographics of solar irrigation in Nepal. *Energy Research & Social Science*. <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4002338>. **Co-author.**
- 2021** Exploring Migration and Disaster Nexus. *The South Asianist Journal*, 8, 10-40.
<http://www.southasianist.ed.ac.uk/article/view/5208>. **Co-author.**
The COVID-19 pandemic not only poses challenges but also opens opportunities for sustainable transformation. *Earth's Future*, <https://doi.org/10.1029/2021EF001996>. **Co-author.**
- 2020** Transformative Engagements with Gender Relations in Agriculture and Water Governance. New Angle: *Nepal*

Journal of Social Science and Public Policy special issue on Water security and inclusive water governance in the Himalayas. 5 (1), 128-158. **Co-author.**

Whose river, is it? An assessment of livelihood and cultural water flow requirements for the Karnali basin. *Ecology and Society* 25 (3):22. [online] URL: <https://www.ecologyandsociety.org/vol25/iss3/art22/> **Co-author.**

2019 Unravelling gendered practices in Nepal water Bureaucracies. *Water Policy* (1-17).

<https://doi.org/10.2166/wp.2019.238-> **Lead author.**

Masculinities in Hydropower: A feminist political ecology perspective. *International Journal of the Commons*. 13 (1). DOI: <http://doi.org/10.18352/ijc.920> **Lead author.**

2016 The Effects of Migration on Livelihoods, Land Management, and Vulnerability to Natural Disasters in the Harpan Watershed in Western Nepal. *Mountain Research and Development*. 36 (4). **Co-author.**

2015 Does outmigration lead to land degradation? Labour shortage and land management in a western Nepal watershed, *Journal of Applied Geography*, Volume,157–170. **Co-author.**

Women in Post-Conflict Nepal: Engendering the issues of women IDPs in national regimes. *Refugee Watch: A South Asian Journal on Forced Migration*. 43 & 44, MCRG, Kolkata, India. **Lead author.**

2014 A compromising consensus? Legitimizing local government in post-conflict Nepal', *International Development Planning Review*, 36 (4) 435-452, Liverpool University Press. **Co-author.**

Journal Articles in preparation

- Youth Migration, Gender and Rural Agrarian Transformation in Nepal: Access and Aspirations. **Lead author.**
- Gendered social capital and collective sustainability of water resources in west Nepal. **Lead author.**
- Irrigation meets Feminist Political Ecology: Exploring Nature-Society Relations in the Context of Climate Change and the Global Environmental Crisis. **Co-author.**

Book Chapters

2022 Covid19, gender and small-scale farming in Nepal. In: Castellanos, Paige., Sachs, Carolyn., and Tickamyer, Ann. Gender. Food, and COVID19. 1st Edition. Routledge. London. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003198277>. **Co-author.**

2017 Women, Peace and Security: The Case of Nepal. In Kolas (eds.) Women, Peace and Security in Nepal: From Civil War to Post Conflict Reconstruction. Routledge. Pp. 99-121. **Lead author.**

The road to parliament: Women in Nepal's representative assemblies. In Kolas (eds.) Women, Peace and Security in Nepal: From Civil War to Post Conflict Reconstruction. Routledge. Pp. 9-31. **Co-author.**

Linking Development, Migration, and Mobility: Reflections from Nepal. In K. Sudmeier-Rieux et al. (eds.) Identifying Emerging Issues in Disaster Risk Reduction, Migration, Climate Change and Sustainable Development. Springer International Publishing, Switzerland. Pp.145-160. **Co-author.**

What happened to Nepal's Women Maoist? In book: R. Manchanda (ed.) Women and Politics of Peace: South Asia Narratives on Militarization, Power and Justice, Sage Publications, Pp. 178-186. **Lead author.**

Research Reports [Selected]

2023 Menstrual Hygiene and Health mainstreaming in sectoral policies in South Asia. UNICEF ROSA. Kathmandu (Unpublished). **Lead author.**

- 2021** Effectiveness of Water adaptation responses in reducing climate-related risks: A meta-review. Australian Centre for International Agricultural Research.
<https://www.aciar.gov.au/sites/default/files/2021-08/final-report-wac2020-157.pdf> **Co-author.**
 Understanding barriers and opportunities for scaling sustainable and inclusive farmer-led irrigation development in Nepal. Kathmandu, Nepal: Cereal Systems Initiative for South Asia (CSISA). 92p.
- 2018** Local Rights Systems and Agrarian Structure: Insights from Digo Jal Bikas Case Study sites in Far-West Nepal. IWMI, Nepal (Unpublished). **Co-author.**
- 2017** Water Security and Well-being in Karnali, Mohana and Mahakali watershed in Far-West Nepal – A gender perspective. IWMI, Nepal (Unpublished). **Lead author.**
 Men, masculinities and hydropower in Sikkim, India. Netherlands Organization for Scientific Research. (Unpublished). **Lead author.**

Conference Papers

- Gender differences in water security and capabilities in Far-West Nepal. In: Proceedings of 8th Regional Conference of International Commission on Irrigation and Drainage (8ARC), 2-4 May 2018, Kathmandu, Nepal. pp. 83-99.
- Men, masculinities and hydropower in Sikkim, India. In: XVI Biennial Conference, 'Practicing the commons: Selfgovernance, cooperation, and institutional change' of The International Association of the Study of the Commons (IASC), Utrecht, 10-17 July 2017.

Training Manuals/Guidelines

- 2021** Participatory Gender Workshop Manual. A guide for critical reflections on gender norms, roles and relations in water, sanitation and hygiene in communities. IWMI-Nepal, Water for Women Fund.
[participatory_gender_training_workshop.pdf \(cgiar.org\)](#)
 A Guide Document on GESI mainstreaming in WASH Plans in Rural Municipalities in Nepal. IWMI-Nepal, Water for Women Fund.

Media Publications

- 2022** Women's leadership in the Water, Energy, Food and Ecosystem (WEFE) Nexus in Nepal: From appearance to reality. IWMI.
 Gender Barriers to Irrigation Technology. Agrilinks.
 Technology for Whom. Solar Irrigation pumps, women and smallholders in Eastern Tarai. The Republica.
- 2021** Youth Migration, Gender and Rural Agrarian Transformation (In the Nepali language), Online Khabar. "Reflections from a transformative space". Gender at Work.
 Transformative engagements – a new way to discuss gender relations in agriculture. Thrive, CGIAR.
- 2020** Unravelling Gendered Practices in Nepal's Public Water Sector. Thrive, CGIAR
 To counter COVID-19 in Nepal, we must support small-scale women farmers. Thive, CGIAR
 The challenges of remote research in tackling sensitive questions. Author Aid.
- 2019** Gender solutions for sustainable water management in Western Nepal. IWMI.
 Gender, Social Capital and Collective Action: A gender perspective on collective sustainability of water resource governance in west Nepal. Colombo, Sri Lanka: International Water Management Institute (IWMI). CGIAR Research Program on Water, Land and Ecosystems (WLE). <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/106348>
- 2018** Why do we need to discuss masculinity in the water sector? Thrive, CGIAR
 Should we still focus on women farmers. The Kathmandu Post.
 Unacknowledged Irrigators. The Kathmandu Post.

- 2014** Women on the move: Gender shapes mobility and thus, constitutes an arena where female empowerment in Nepal can be discussed, The Kathmandu Post.

Presentations at International Conferences

- International Conference on Nature-Society Relations and the Global Environmental Crisis. Thinking on Climate Change and Sustainability from the Fields of Intersectional Theory and Transdisciplinary Gender Studies. 4th – 6th May, **2023**. The Center for Transdisciplinary Gender Studies at Humboldt- Universität zu Berlin. Irrigation meets Feminist Political Ecology: Exploring Nature-Society Relations in the Context of Climate Change and the Global Environmental Crisis.
- Regional Forum “Energizing Agriculture and Enabling Just Energy Transitions in South Asia”. 6th February – 8th February, **2023**. Technology for whom. Solar Irrigation Pumps, women and smallholders in Eastern Tarai, Nepal.
- Asia Water Forum. 9th August **2022**. Solar Irrigation Pumps, women and smallholders in Eastern Tarai.
- International Conference on Women in STEM, 20 September 2019. Kathmandu. Unravelling Gendered Practices in Public Water Sector in Nepal.
- Stockholm World Water Week, 24th – 31st August **2019**. Sweden. Unravelling Gendered Practices in Public Water Sector in Nepal. SIWI Grant, 2019.
- XVII Biennial IASC Conference ‘In Defense of the Commons: Challenges, Innovation, and Action, Lima, Peru, July 1-5, **2019**. Gender, Social Capital and Collective Management of Water Resources in West Nepal.
- 8th International seminar on Institutional Challenges and Water Security in Irrigation Systems: Consideration from Climate Change and Population Dynamics. May 6, **2019**. Kathmandu, Nepal. Gender, Social Capital and Collective Management of Water Resources in West Nepal.
- 8th Regional Conference of International Commission on Irrigation and Drainage, Kathmandu, Nepal. 2-4 May **2018**. Gender differences in water security and capabilities in Far-West Nepal.
- IASC2017 Conference (Utrecht, The Netherlands, July 10-14, **2017**; Paper presentation - ‘Men, Masculinity and Hydropower Development in Northeast India’. Agriterra Grant, 2017.
- Seminar on Ideology and Social Science, November 27-28, **2014**, OKD Institute of Social Change and Development: Guwahati, India. The changing face of leadership in Nepal: Women and Ideology.
- International Conference on ‘Gender, Empowerment and Conflict in South Asia’ 7-8 November **2014**, Kolkata, India. Making Women Count for Peace: Gender, Empowerment, and Conflict in Nepal).
- European Conferences on South Asian Studies, 23-26th July **2014** University of Zurich, Switzerland. In Making of an Equal Citizen: An Ethnography of emerging female leadership in transitional Nepal – A Local Perspective. Award: ECSAS travel grant and fee waiver, 2014.

Panel Speaker

- Panelist - on the interlinkages between Water and food justice systems at Food Systems for New Realities - Agri4D 2021, international online conference Agri4D 28-30 September 2021
- Panelist in Webinar - Negotiating Gender Expertise in Environment and Development, 15 April 2021. NWCF, PEI, IWMI.
- Speaker – GESI and WASH, broadcasted by Radio Ujyallo (Nepali) on March 22, 2021, <https://ujyaaloonline.com/ujyaalo-radio-live/>
- Panelist - Women in Science. WIRES. One CGIAR. February 2021.
- Gender and Hydropower in Nepal. May 2019, ICIMOD, Nepal.

- Doing gender: what does gender and/or feminist perspective mean in research and advocacy? March 2017, Martin Chautari, Nepal.
- CGAIR A new type of Gender Training, March 2, 2017. Gender and social inclusion (GESI) –The status quo in the organization and at the project level, and experiences from the implementation of Participatory Gender Training Manual in the field.

Guest Lectures

- MA, Gender and Environment. Kathmandu University, Nepal.
- MA, Social research methods, Kathmandu University, Nepal.
- MSc. Integrating gender into research: Gender and Environment. Tribhuwan University, Nepal
- BBA. Gender and Tourism Geography, Lumbini Buddhist University, Nepal.

Reviewer for Peer Reviewed Journals

Agriculture and Human Values, New Angle: Nepal journal of social science and public policy, Climate and development, Gender, Technology and Development.

Research Supervision

Bachelor Student, Wageningen University, the Netherlands - Hydraulic property creation in rural Western Nepal: A case study on changing hydraulic property and water access arrangements in rural western Nepal
 MPhil Student, Tribhuwan University, Nepal – Fostering inclusivity in WASH through the private sector.

Language Skills

Nepali, English, Hindi, Bengali (verbal)

Computer Skills and Competencies

MS Office, Graphic design applications (Adobe Illustrator™, Photoshop™, Coral Draw, Page Maker); Knowledge of GIS and Remote Sensing, MAXQDA, Atlas ti., NVIVO, Endnote, SPSS.